



ASSEMBLY
Elections 08



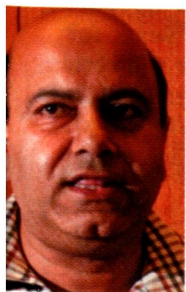
VIJAY Chowk

SIPRA DAS



How many Vijays does it take for the BJP to score a victory over Chief Minister Sheila Dikshit? Clearly one is not enough. First, it was a toss-up between BJP General Secretary Vijay Goel and Lok Sabha deputy leader Vijay Kumar Malhotra. The senior Vijay won. When it came to fielding a candidate to take on Dikshit from her New Delhi constituency, the BJP again zeroed in on another Vijay—the ever smiling Vijay Jolly. That's the way BJP's playing the game. *by Priya Sahgal*

DIKSHIT (TOP); JOLLY (BELOW LEFT); AND MALHOTRA



If Look-Alikes COULD KILL

Guess who's coming for tea? It could well be Hrithik Roshan or even Sachin Tendulkar. Well, almost. Brijmohan Aggarwal, a BJP MLA from Raipur, has hit upon a novel strategy of getting celebrity look-alikes to canvass for him. He claims this is the current rage.

Minus Marx

CPI(M) has poached on its Left ally CPI by getting Mohammed Raza to switch sides. Raza was to contest from Delhi's Okhla on a CPI ticket. No full Marx for this one.



Family Matters

It's a parivar campaign for Vasundhara Raje. While son Dushyant played host at her famous tea party, daughter-in-law Niharika, a Gujjar, hit the campaign trail to woo the Gujjar vote. As the K-soaps usually say, "*Bahu ho to aisi.*"

Rs 1.2 crore is the value of assets declared by Ajit Jogi in his nomination papers, a 40-fold increase from five years ago.

TICKET TO RIDE

The list of Madhya Pradesh Congress is being finalised in Delhi, which means daily trips for the state leaders to the Capital to lobby for seats. So much so, that the train Shaan-e-Bhopal is now known as the High Command Express.

The Raman Effect

The Chhattisgarh chief minister launched his Vikas Yatra a couple of months before the polls. The yatra centres around just one theme—Raman Singh. Adopting the Modi formula, the BJP has disconnected state politics from the national. Very few posters of Advani or Rajnath, no national issues are raised, it's just Raman all the way.



SAURABH SINGH

Symbolic FIGHT

The BJP has given its ally, the Akali Dal, four seats in Delhi but with a catch. It wants the Akalis to fight the election on its symbol. But the Akalis do not quite agree.